Hangva Council of Elders

Resource Identifier: CULT-CUST-002

English Translation: Traditional Village Governance Council

Category: Custom | Subcategory: Governance

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Clan Representatives (Documented in Horam 1977, Hodson 1911)

License: Cultural Heritage / Public Documentation (Permissions: community_authorized)

Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Continuous customary governance council

---

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Customary governing council of village clan leaders (Hangva) assisting the Awunga (hereditary chief). Mediates property boundaries, inter-clan disputes, and customary fines.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Hangvawui ning mashunglak aina ramwui tui khamata sai."

"Awungali ngasoda kashan kachiva kashak ngachek."

"Phungcham, Hunphun, Ukhrul kachida Hangvawui tui ngana."

English Translation & Meaning:

"With upright justice, the Hangva Council deliberates on vital matters of land and law."

"Assisting the Awunga, they uphold ancestral covenants and settle village disputes."

"Across every Tangkhul village, the voice of the Hangva is heeded with deep deference."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Representation of each clan by its senior hereditary elder on the Hangva Council.
2. Convening at the Awunga’s courtyard to hear boundary, marriage, or customary property cases.
3. Hearing testimonies from disputants and witnesses under solemn oaths.
4. Deliberation based on unwritten customary jurisprudence (Chanjam).
5. Issuance of binding verdict and enforcement of customary restitution (Khayor).

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Awunga (Chief), Hereditary Clan Heads (Hangva), Village Witnesses

---